

PEOPLE STRATEGY • ORGANISATION DESIGN • CHANGE EXECUTION

Workforce Transformation Strategy Plan

A structured, fair and accountable framework for redesigning work, shaping future capability and managing organisational change.

HOW TO USE THIS TEMPLATE

Adapt before you act

This template converts a restructuring playbook into an organisation-neutral workforce transformation plan. Replace all placeholders—such as **(company)**, **(Transformation Review Board)**, **(People/HR Business Partner)**, internal tools and local approvals—before use.

> **Important:** This is an operational template, not legal advice. Obtain advice from qualified employment, labour and data-protection specialists in every relevant jurisdiction before any decision, consultation, notification or implementation activity.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Accountability

Executive sponsor: _____
Plan owner: _____
People/HR lead: _____
Legal lead: _____

Review details

Effective date: _____
Next review: _____
Version: _____
Classification: _____

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01 • GOVERNANCE

Confidentiality, ownership & escalation

This plan is the source of truth for the strategy and execution of workforce transformation at **(company)**. All participating teams must follow the guidance to support alignment, consistency, fairness and compliance.

> **Confidentiality notice:** Everyone participating in this work should complete **(company)'s confidentiality acknowledgement or form** at the earliest opportunity, confirming their understanding of and commitment to keeping relevant information confidential.

TRANSFORMATION REVIEW BOARD

If the current process does not work for the organisation, escalate to the **(Transformation Review Board)**. The Board should include appropriate representatives from People Strategy/Transformation, Employee Relations, Legal, Equality/Inclusion and People Operations. Any proposed change to approved documents, templates or processes must be reviewed and approved by this group.

ESCALATE WHEN CONSIDERING

- **Assessments:** any new or modified assessment.
- **Templates:** any update to an official template in use.
- **Exceptions:** any change to existing reduction-in-force or workforce-change exception guidance, including severance-related exceptions.

APPROVED STANDARDS

Skills-assessment criteria and weighting are fixed and must not be changed without approval from the **(Transformation Review Board)**.

> **EMEA standard:** Any EMEA action that may approach or exceed statutory collective-dismissal thresholds must be escalated to local Legal and the **(EMEA approval authority / exit committee)**.

Our workforce transformation approach

GUIDING PRINCIPLES

Transformation priorities

Enable leaders and HR Business Partners to make strategic business decisions against the organisation's transformation priorities.

Business needs

Ensure the business can transform and organise for sustainable, profitable growth.

Accountability

Hold executive leadership and their teams accountable for decisions made on behalf of their organisation.

Respect

Communicate clearly and directly with potentially affected employees; ensure they hear news first and receive appropriate support.

Equality

Maintain the organisation's equality focus and commitment throughout all stages.

Scalable & effective

Provide appropriate time and resources for thoughtful, consistent employee experience.

Brand & culture

Weigh actions against downstream impacts on the external brand and internal culture.

Process integrity

Use evidence, documentation, review and suitable challenge before decisions are finalised.

"Start with the future work and capability the organisation needs—not the individuals currently in role."

Vision first, then organisation & talent

Redesigning an organisation begins with a clear vision and priorities to guide organisation design and talent decisions. Before finalising any elimination decisions, design the organisation around business priorities and assess opportunities to reskill, redeploy and reassign talent to fill internal gaps.

1

Set vision & priorities

Establish vision and priorities based on business outlook, financial constraints and company goals. Communicate early and often to bring employees through the journey with no surprises.

2

Design the new organisation

Determine how critical work should be organised. Identify the capabilities required to deliver the new vision and objectives effectively and efficiently.

3

Determine talent implications

Assess the talent necessary to deliver the new vision and priorities. Identify work and roles that are no longer needed, only after the future-state organisation has been designed.

> **Decision sequence:** Business strategy → future work → organisation design → capabilities → talent implications → appropriate redeployment/reskilling assessment → any role-change process.

CORE LEADERSHIP EXPECTATION

Leaders should articulate the business rationale, future operating model and associated people implications. People/HR Business Partners should challenge any attempt to identify individuals before vision, priorities and organisation design are established.

BUSINESS QUESTIONS

Questions leaders must answer

STRATEGY & PRIORITIES

- What is the vision for the organisation? What objectives and priorities must be achieved?
- What work is critical to delivering that vision and those priorities?

HOW WORK SHOULD BE ORGANISED

- What leadership team and roles are needed to drive critical work?
- What structure and accountabilities will deliver the vision and priorities?
- Which roles must work closely together? Where is work too distributed?
- Where does work require closer management, direction or oversight?
- What senior-talent investment best serves the future critical work? What seniority ratio is appropriate?
- What organisational-health indicators show opportunities for adjustment? What spans and layers are optimal for the future state?

POTENTIAL ROLE CHANGES

- Which roles require only a discussion and a job-code or HRIS data change?
- Which roles may be eliminated, subject to a selection process, or changed in grade?
- What are the job descriptions and responsibilities of any changed-grade roles?
- What expectations change for receiving managers, including managerial responsibility and work output?

ROLE ARCHITECTURE

Aligning on position-elimination types

When identifying impacted roles, each position elimination should align to an approved category. Categories must describe the business and work change—not the individual.

1. **Location strategy**
   Location strategy has changed, with positions eliminated in one location and consolidated or backfilled in another.

2. **Work elimination**
   Work is eliminated due to completion, discontinuation, outsourcing, or absorption through system and process improvements.

3. **Skill-set elimination**
   Skills are no longer required due to automation, strategic deprioritisation based on market outlook, or misalignment with the role grade.

4. **Excess capacity**
   Work shifts to other employees, teams consolidate, management layers are removed, or span of control changes, resulting in the elimination of some positions.

> **Use with care:** Apply local legal requirements, selection-pool rules and consultation obligations before finalising any classification or action.

DECISION QUALITY

Fair, objective, data-driven decisions

Role-elimination decisions must be grounded in data, business needs and future priorities. The business first designs its structure based on strategic priorities; teams then complete a **(Business Justification)** and **(Case for Change)**. A formal **(Skills Assessment)**, where applicable, objectively evaluates and compares skills required for roles.

FAIRNESS QUESTIONS

- Are decisions based on objective data, such as critical skills, future needs, vision, strategy and priorities—not personal relationships or bias?
- Are the same standards and criteria applied consistently across teams and roles?
- Is the rationale for each elimination documented and tied to a strategic shift or business-need change, focusing on the work or skill eliminated rather than the individual?
- Is the language objective, factual and data-driven? Can the organisational change and impact be understood by someone unfamiliar with the organisation?
- Have employee skills been assessed and documented against future needs before any ranking or comparative selection exercise?

REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION

Completion of the **(Business Justification Form)**, **(Case for Change Template)** and, where applicable, **(Skills Assessment)** is a required step in the workforce transformation process.

DECISION QUALITY

Key considerations when finalising lists

SELECTION CRITERIA & ROLE CONSISTENCY

- Have redeployment opportunities been assessed, including for high performers?
- Is the role eliminated in one team while the organisation is actively hiring for it elsewhere?
- Were the same criteria used to identify roles for elimination—for example, same job title and grade—or were special exceptions made?

EMPLOYEES ON LEAVE OF ABSENCE

- Was the role-elimination decision made independently of the employee's leave status? Would they still meet selection criteria if actively at work?
- Does a manager's justification refer to availability, reliability or attendance?

EXTERNAL REACTIONS & OPTICS

- Is the employee a prominent public figure or a key customer/industry influencer?
- Could the departure trigger a wider pattern of voluntary resignations?

ORGANISATION HEALTH

- Does the action create a span-of-control risk due to too few or too many reports?
- Is the manager in a different region or time zone?
- Do planned eliminations align with the location strategy, without creating regional imbalance or loss of local support?

Roles & accountability — functional lead

FUNCTIONAL LEAD HR BUSINESS PARTNER

- Serve as a change champion and mentor, supporting leaders and HR Business Partners in organisation design and work reshaping.
- Provide guidance and answer questions through every stage of strategy and process.
- Own master-list submissions for each relevant leadership group or function.
- Consolidate documentation and serve as a single point of accountability for leadership.
- Partner closely with submitting HR Business Partners to flag missing documents, late leader decisions and other risks.
- Monitor dashboards and master records for progress on impact-list submission and audit for complete information.

FUNCTIONAL & REGIONAL HR BUSINESS PARTNERS

Participating HR Business Partners support strategic design, process completion and local execution in partnership with business leaders, Employee Relations, Legal and other relevant teams.

> **Accountability principle:** Business leaders own strategy, organisation priorities and final decisions. HR Business Partners enable quality, challenge process risk and ensure the rationale is evidenced and appropriately documented.

Roles & accountability — delivery teams

FUNCTIONAL & REGIONAL HRBP RESPONSIBILITIES

- Lead strategic organisation-design conversations; prevent a premature move to identifying individuals.
- Ask questions that help leaders be intentional rather than reactive.
- Determine communication and transition plans; consider impacts on team dynamics, culture and engagement.
- Complete the Business Justification, Case for Change and Skills Assessment thoroughly with business leaders.
- Submit impact lists and documentation through the Functional Lead; validate completeness, access and evidence.
- Provide additional rationale or documents during Employee Relations, Legal and Equality reviews.
- Facilitate notifier-enablement sessions and partner with Employee Communications on relevant plans.

CENTRAL TEAM RESPONSIBILITIES

- Maintain the project plan, milestones, guidance, communications templates and an approved collaboration channel for questions.
- Build and operate an efficient impact-list submission and management process.
- Prepare key non-People partners, such as Events, Security and IT, where appropriate.
- Conduct relevant audits, including employee-representation, long-service, site or promotion considerations, in line with law and policy.
- Determine whether collective-dismissal or mass-layoff thresholds are triggered.
- Involve HRBP, Legal, Employee Relations, Labour Relations and business leaders to identify regional procedural steps and exception requests early.

BUSINESS LEADERS

Provide clear strategy, organisation priorities and final decisions; remain accountable for the rationale behind role eliminations.

CENTRALISED PROCESS & TIMELINE

A standard 12-week planning horizon

The following timeline assumes a standard centralised workforce-transformation window of 12 weeks. It may vary based on size, complexity, jurisdictions and affected teams.

1–4

Plan & design

HRBP and business leaders attend enablement, design the organisation, identify potential impacts only after strategy work, and assess cost implications with Finance Business Partner or equivalent.

5–6

Document & submit

HRBPs complete Business Justification, Case for Change and Skills Assessment where required. Central teams review and audit documents. HRBPs submit impact lists and deliverables; follow the organisation’s cut-off rules for later additions.

7–9

Review

Employee Relations, Legal and Equality/Inclusion complete reviews and adverse-impact analysis where applicable.

10–11

Prepare

Finalise enablement and communications plans, including drafts, approvals and employee notification materials.

CENTRALISED PROCESS & TIMELINE

Notification, consultation & timing

12

Leader enablement & early awareness

Deliver notifier enablement; provide early awareness to relevant senior leadership; where lawful and appropriate, manage any executive-level notifications according to the approved plan.

N

Notification & consultation

Business leaders notify affected employees in individual meetings, subject to legal requirements. Begin works-council, union or other consultation processes where applicable.

+60

Post-notification

Manage notice, support, redeployment, consultation and termination sequencing in line with local law, contractual obligations and approved plans. Any indicative time period must not override local legal requirements.

TIMING CONSIDERATIONS

Confirm statutory and contractual notice periods, including local social-plan requirements. Account early for administrative steps and local timelines across regions to mitigate unanticipated delays.

NOTIFIER ENABLEMENT & EMPLOYEE PACKETS

HRBP leaders should host notifier enablement for each function or leadership group at least one day before notification, unless local legal requirements require a different sequence. Consider global impacts and align with local HRBP and Employee Relations partners; hold country-specific enablement as needed.

Employee notification materials should be finalised, quality-checked and issued to authorised notifiers under the approved timeline and security controls.

PROCESS RIGOUR

Controls that protect fairness & execution

DOCUMENTATION

No submission should be accepted without an attached Case for Change and, where required, Skills Assessment.

VERSION CONTROL

Use an approved, access-controlled central system of record for all submissions. Keep a clear version history, role-based access and an auditable record of changes.

AUDITS

HRBPs and Functional Lead HRBPs should conduct regular completeness audits and flag gaps to the appropriate HRBPs and leadership.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

HRBPs and leaders must disclose personal or reporting-line relationships with potentially affected employees to the **(Transformation Review Board)** before exception reviews.

DATA PROTECTION & SECURITY

Restrict information to authorised individuals, retain records only as necessary, and apply appropriate privacy, security and retention requirements to all assessment, consultation and impact-list data.

> **Do not use generic shared drives or open collaboration channels for sensitive workforce-change information.** Use approved systems with access controls and a clear audit trail.

Centralised impact-list submission

To support consistency, accuracy and accountability, designated Functional Lead HRBPs should own and manage impact-list submissions at the appropriate leadership or function level.

HOW IT WORKS

- All submissions are centralised in an approved, access-controlled workforce-transformation register or system of record.
- Each register is managed by the designated Functional Lead HRBP.
- When an HRBP is ready to submit a list with supporting documentation, they contact the assigned Functional Lead HRBP for access to the correct register.
- The Functional Lead HRBP grants appropriate access and ensures names and documentation are added to the master list.

REQUIRED INFORMATION

- Employee ID, employee name and submitting HRBP.
- Notifier name and ID.
- Position-elimination type, reason and rationale for the reason selection.
- Whether the headcount will be reinvested; if so, whether location or grade will change.
- Whether redeployment is planned or being considered.
- Link to the completed Case for Change.
- Link to Skills Assessment where applicable.
- Confirmation that supporting records are shared with the authorised review group through an approved secure method.

Prepare leaders, people & the organisation

Central messaging

Develop, approve and control core messaging through **(Employee Communications / authorised communications lead)**.

Organisation updates

Leaders share organisation updates at the appropriate time and in the appropriate sequence, consistent with consultation and legal requirements.

Notifier enablement

HRBPs facilitate notifier enablement for the relevant leadership level, covering purpose, process, individual meetings, questions, support and escalation.

Readiness

Coordinate with security, IT, payroll, benefits, communications, Employee Relations, Legal and local stakeholders so employee support is ready when needed.

FINAL IMPLEMENTATION CHECK

- Strategy, future-state organisation and talent implications are documented.
- Required approvals, impact analyses, legal reviews and consultation steps are complete or appropriately sequenced.
- All decisions have an objective, work-focused and evidence-based rationale.
- Confidential information is protected and only authorised people have access.
- Notifiers are equipped to communicate clearly, directly and respectfully.
- Employee support, redeployment and transition resources are ready.

Thoughtful workforce transformation protects people, preserves trust and enables the future organisation.